

JAMES LEINER

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jamesleiner.github.io [◇ Google Scholar](#)

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University — Doctor of Philosophy in Statistics 2021 – 2026 (expected)

Thesis: Advances in Human-in-the-Loop Inference

Advisor: Aaditya Ramdas

Committee: Larry Wasserman, Jing Lei, Lucas Janson, and Daniela Witten

The University of Chicago — Master of Science in Statistics 2019 – 2021

Thesis: Novel Data Splitting Techniques for Post-Selection Inference in Poisson Regression

Advisor: Rina Barber

The University of Chicago — Bachelor of Arts in Mathematics and Economics 2010 – 2013

PUBLICATIONS AND PREPRINTS

James Leiner, Aurélien Bibaut, Nathan Kallus, Aaditya Ramdas, and Koulik Khamaru. Adaptive Inference for Functionals of M -Estimands. *in preparation*, 2026.

James Leiner, Robin Dunn, and Aaditya Ramdas. Adaptive off-policy inference for M -estimators under misspecification. *arXiv:2509.14218*, 2025.

James Leiner, Brian Manzo, Aaditya Ramdas, and Wesley Tansey. Scalable causal structure learning via amortized conditional independence testing. *4th Conference on Causal Learning and Reasoning (CLeaR)*, 2025. **(Oral)**

James Leiner, Boyan Duan, Larry Wasserman, and Aaditya Ramdas. Rejoinder to the Discussion of “Data fission: splitting a single data point”. *Journal of the American Statistical Association (JASA)*, 2025.

James Leiner and Aaditya Ramdas. Graph fission and cross-validation. *27th International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics (AISTATS)*, 2024.

James Leiner, Boyan Duan, Larry Wasserman, and Aaditya Ramdas. Data fission: splitting a single data point. *Journal of the American Statistical Association (JASA)*, 2023. **(Discussion Paper)**

TALKS AND INVITED SESSIONS

IMS International Conference on Statistics and Data Science, *Adaptive inference for M -estimators* December 2025

Conference on Causal Learning and Reasoning, *Scalable causal structure learning* May 2025

Meta Central Applied Science Research Seminar, *Data fission and Gaussian Process regression* January 2025

Joint Statistical Meeting, *Data fission: splitting a single data point (discussion paper talk)* August 2024

International Seminar on Selective Inference, *“Inference after Latent Variable Estimation” discussant* June 2022

International Seminar on Selective Inference, *Data fission: splitting a single data point* May 2022

RESEARCH INTERNSHIPS

Meta, Research Scientist Intern Summer 2026

- Developed synthetic control methods to estimate average treatment effect for advertising campaigns

Novartis Pharmaceuticals Corporation, Biostatistics Intern Summer 2024

- Developed causal inference and off-policy evaluation methods for adaptively collected clinical trial data
- *Publication*: Adaptive off-policy inference for M -estimators under misspecification (preprint)

Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center, Research Intern Summer 2022

- Developed causal discovery methods to identify genetic biomarkers predictive of cancer metastases

- *Publication*: Scalable causal structure learning via amortized conditional independence testing (**CLearR**)

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Novantas (now Curinos), Engagement Manager

2014–2016, 2017–2019

Promoted Associate → Lead Associate → Senior Associate → Engagement Manager

(*financial services management consultancy*)

- Led quantitative consulting engagements (3–7 person teams) for retail and commercial banks across deposit pricing, treasury management fee pricing, stress testing, funds transfer pricing, asset/liability management, and credit risk
- Managed client and stakeholder relationships at regional and multinational banks in the U.S., Canada, and Australia.
- Built SAS/Python tooling to automate development and validation of ARIMA, Cox PH, random forest, and GLM models
- Designed mortgage early-warning systems for a Big Four Australian bank to identify loans at high risk of delinquency

Facebook (now Meta), Quantitative Analyst

2016

- Developed data infrastructure and analytical reporting systems supporting large-scale marketing campaigns

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Carnegie Mellon University

Machine Learning Capstone Course (46-983)

Fall 2025

Natural Language Processing (46-924)

Fall 2024

Statistical Machine Learning I (46-926)

Fall 2024

ABCDE of Machine Learning (36-708)

Spring 2023

Statistical Machine Learning (35-708)

Spring 2022

Modern Regression (34-601)

Fall 2021

Teaching Assistant, University of Chicago

Applied Regression Analysis (BUSN 41100), *Booth School of Business*

Fall 2020

Pre-Calculus (MATH 10500)

Fall 2011

HONORS AND AWARDS

Runner-up Poster Award, *12th International Conference on Multiple Comparisons Procedures*

Fall 2022

Departmental Scholarship, *The University of Chicago*

Fall 2019

General Honors, *The University of Chicago*

Fall 2013

Dean's List, *The University of Chicago*

2010–2013

National Merit Corporate Scholarship, *Marsh and McLennan Companies*

2010

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer: Journal of the American Statistical Association (3), Journal of the Royal Statistical Society Series B, Electronic Journal of Statistics, Biometrika, NeurIPS

COMPUTER SKILLS

Coding Python (NumPy, pandas, scikit-learn, PyTorch), R (tidyverse, ggplot2), SAS, SQL